MIT MYSORE

UI/UX Style Guide

Maharaja Institute of Technology Mysore Examination System

DESIGN PURPOSE

Prepared as the shared reference for the MIT Mysore examination-system frontend and backend teams. The official college logo will be inserted in the top-left brand position after it is supplied.

WORKING DESIGN DOCUMENT

Version 1.0 | 12 November 2026

1. Purpose and design principles

This guide defines the shared visual language for the Principal, HOD, COE and Student portals. The goal is to make the system feel like one dependable college platform, even though each role has different tasks.

Principle	What it means in the interface
Clear and task-focused	Put the user's most important next action first. Avoid decorative dashboard clutter.
Consistent across portals	Use the same colors, typography, buttons, form patterns, status labels and spacing.
Secure by design	Show only information that the signed-in role is allowed to see. Never expose answer keys in student screens.
Accessible	Use readable type, strong contrast, visible focus states and labels that do not rely on color alone.
Operational clarity	Make states such as Draft, Finalized, Ready for Transfer and Approved easy to understand.
Responsive	Support desktop and laptop first, while remaining usable on tablets and smaller screens.

2. Brand identity and college logo

The product is the Maharaja Institute of Technology Mysore Examination System. The team nickname must not appear in product names, page titles, logos, navigation, footers or user-facing messages.

Placement	Standard
Primary logo location	Top-left brand area of the main sidebar on desktop. Place the official MIT logo to the left of the text label “Maharaja Institute of Technology Mysore” when space permits.
Login pages	Place the logo at the top-left of the main content or in the upper brand block. Keep it clear of form fields.
Collapsed sidebar	Show the logo mark only, with an accessible text label or tooltip.
Mobile layout	Place the logo in the top-left of the app bar; do not shrink it until it becomes unreadable.
Asset handling	Use the official image supplied by the user. Do not redraw, recolor, crop tightly, distort or invent a replacement logo.
Clear space	Leave breathing room around the logo equal to at least the height of the logo mark.

> **LOGO ASSET PENDING**
> The official MIT logo has not yet been supplied. Use a temporary, clearly labeled logo placeholder during development and replace it with the provided asset without changing the layout.

3. Color system

Use the palette consistently. Navy anchors navigation and institutional identity; blue is the main action color; violet is a secondary accent. Status colors should be reserved for actual status meaning.

Token	Hex	Use
Navy	#17243A	Sidebar, primary headings, dark brand surfaces
Primary blue	#2563EB	Primary buttons, active links, selected controls
Secondary violet	#6D5CE8	Secondary emphasis, charts and selected highlights
Page background	#F5F7FB	Main application background
Surface white	#FFFFFF	Cards, dialogs, forms and tables
Primary text	#1F2937	Body copy and table text
Muted text	#64748B	Helper text, timestamps and secondary labels
Border	#D9E2EF	Dividers, table borders and input outlines
Success	#16834A	Verified, approved, completed
Warning	#B7791F	Pending, needs attention, expiring
Error	#B42318	Rejected, failed validation, blocked

COLOR ACCESSIBILITY

Do not communicate status by color alone. Pair each status color with a readable label and, where useful, an icon. Check text contrast before release.

4. Typography

Text level	Recommended size	Use
Page title	24-30 px	One clear title at the top of each major page
Section title	18-22 px	Major content groups and dashboard sections
Card or panel title	14-16 px	Compact component headings
Body text	14-16 px	Main readable content
Table text	13-14 px	Dense but readable information
Helper / metadata	12-13 px	Hints, timestamps and secondary context

5. Layout and navigation

Desktop application frame

TOP-LEFT BRAND AREA: Official MIT logo + institution name

LEFT SIDEBAR: Role-specific navigation, active item and profile area

MAIN CONTENT: Page title, short context, primary action, filters and content

OPTIONAL RIGHT PANEL: Contextual details only when the task benefits from it

Use a fixed or sticky left sidebar on desktop, approximately 240-264 px wide when expanded. The main content should have a comfortable maximum width and consistent horizontal padding. Do not place every action in the top bar.

Navigation rules

- Show only navigation items relevant to the signed-in role.
- Keep the active page visually distinct with a subtle blue background and a clear label.
- Group related navigation items under short section labels.
- Use familiar icons consistently and always pair important icons with text.
- Provide a clear page title and breadcrumb for deeper workflows.

6. Core component patterns

Component	Design rule
Primary button	Blue fill, white text, concise action verb. One primary action per main panel.
Secondary button	Neutral or outlined style for supporting actions.
Destructive button	Use red only for irreversible actions; require confirmation.
Text field	Visible label, optional helper text, clear error message and keyboard focus state.
Dropdown / select	Use for defined choices such as department, semester, section or session.
Data table	Clear column names, aligned values, compact row height, search and filters where useful.
Status badge	Short text plus restrained color. Examples: Draft, Frozen, Verified, Rejected, Approved.
Dialog	Use for focused decisions; keep title, consequence and primary/secondary actions explicit.
Toast	Brief success or error feedback. Do not use a toast as the only record of a critical action.
Empty state	Explain why there is no data and show the next valid action when one exists.

7. Forms, tables and data-heavy screens

Forms

- Group related fields into short sections and follow the real workflow order.
- Use explicit labels such as “Examination date” rather than relying on placeholder text.
- Mark required fields and explain validation errors beside the relevant field.
- Preserve entered values when validation fails.
- For file uploads, show accepted formats, file size limits and a clear validation summary.
- For final submission, show a review step and the consequence of locking the data.

Tables

- Keep the most important identifying columns at the left, such as USN, subject or examination ID.
- Use pagination or virtualization for large lists; do not render hundreds of rows without control.
- Make sorting, filtering and search behavior obvious.
- Keep numeric columns aligned and use consistent date and time formats.
- Do not expose protected question text or answer keys in COE or student tables.

8. Status language and workflow feedback

Status	Meaning	Suggested tone
Draft	Work can still be changed	Neutral grey
Submitted	Sent for validation or review	Blue
Finalized / Frozen	Changes are locked for this revision or session	Navy or violet
Ready for transfer	Package has been prepared but not yet accepted by lab	Blue
Verified	Lab server has verified the received package	Green
Rejected	Validation or signature check failed	Red
Pending approval	Results imported but not released	Amber
Approved / Released	COE has approved and released results	Green
Consumed / Retired	Paper is no longer available for future selection	Neutral grey

> **IMPORTANT**
> Do not show “Transferred”, “Verified”, “Encrypted” or “Approved” merely because a user clicked a button. These labels must reflect a confirmed response from the responsible backend or lab service.

9. Responsive behavior and accessibility

Desktop / laptop: full sidebar, multi-column dashboards and wide tables. Tablet: collapsible sidebar, fewer dashboard columns and manageable tables. Mobile: compact app bar, stacked cards, one-column forms and simplified list views.

Accessibility requirements

- All interactive controls must be keyboard accessible.
- Show a visible focus ring; do not remove browser focus without replacement.
- Use semantic headings, buttons, labels and form controls.
- Provide accessible names for icon-only controls.
- Never use color as the sole way to communicate an error or status.
- Respect reduced-motion preferences and avoid distracting animations.
- Keep touch targets comfortably sized on mobile.

10. Loading, error and offline states

State	Required behavior
Loading	Use a restrained spinner or skeleton; prevent accidental duplicate submission.
Validation error	Show the exact field or record that needs correction and how to fix it.
Network error	Explain that the request could not reach the service; preserve safe user input.
Offline lab unavailable	Show that the local lab service is unreachable and prevent a false success state.
No permission	Explain that the signed-in role cannot perform the action; do not expose restricted data.
Session expired	Ask the user to sign in again and return them safely to the intended workflow where possible.

11. Design consistency checklist

- The official MIT logo is at the top-left brand position and is never distorted.
- No team nickname or unrelated product branding appears in the user interface.
- All portals share the same palette, typography, spacing and component behavior.
- Role-specific navigation and access are clear.
- Critical actions require confirmation and show a recorded outcome.
- Protected question content and answer keys are not exposed to unauthorized interfaces.
- The interface distinguishes a local offline state from a central service connection state.

End of UI/UX Style Guide